

Founder Capital Access Toolkit Workbook

Match your company to the right capital paths and build an outreach-ready funding plan.

Resource ID: CAP-01 · Version 1.1 · August 13, 2026

WHO IT'S FOR

Founders preparing to raise non-dilutive, debt, or investor capital.

WHEN TO USE IT

Before any grant, lender, or investor outreach.

WHAT IT PRODUCES

A completed capital-path match, readiness gap list, and outreach action plan.

NEXT STEP INSIDE THE ECOSYSTEM

Work the plan with your Funding Pipeline Tracker (CAP-04). When you need capital strategy tailored to your company, book a VGP advisory session; Growth OS can turn your funding pipeline into a managed operating dashboard.

© 2026 Value Growth Partners. Provided to Founder Network members for their own use. Not legal, financial, investment, or tax advice. Do not redistribute, resell, or share outside your organization.

Capital & funding content is educational. It is not an offer of, or advice on, securities or financing; verify eligibility, terms, and deadlines independently before applying or committing.

THE BRAND BLUEPRINT · Powered by Value Growth Partners · Growth OS

Founder Capital Access Toolkit

Right Capital. Right Time. Right Purpose.

BB-08 | Capital Readiness & Funding Strategy

Prepared for The Brand Blueprint Founder Resource Toolkit by Value Growth Partners. Version 1.0

This toolkit is designed to help founders determine whether they are funding ready, identify the best-fit capital pathway, organize required materials, prepare outreach, and track funding opportunities without duplicating existing Brand Blueprint resources. Use it alongside the Forecasting + KPI Workbook, Pitch Deck Builder, Retail Readiness Toolkit, and Growth OS resources.

How to Use This Toolkit

STEP	TOOL	PURPOSE
01	Capital Readiness Scorecard	Assess whether the business is ready to pursue funding now.
02	Capital Fit Matrix	Match stage, revenue, funding need, and risk tolerance to the right pathway.
03	Capital Data Room Checklist	Organize the documents funders expect before outreach.
04	Funding Outreach Library	Customize channel-specific emails for lenders, accelerators, investors, and partners.
05	Funding Pipeline Tracker	Track deadlines, contacts, status, next steps, probability, and capital pipeline value.

01 | Capital Readiness Scorecard

Score each area from 0 to 2. A score of 0 means not ready, 1 means partially ready, and 2 means ready. Total score guides the recommended next step.

AREA	WHAT TO REVIEW	0	1	2
Business Foundation	Legal entity, EIN, business bank account, licenses, insurance	☐	☐	☐
Revenue Proof	Sales history, ecommerce exports, invoices, purchase orders, contracts, or paid pilots	☐	☐	☐
Financial Clarity	P&L, cashflow forecast, revenue summary, bank statements, margin understanding	☐	☐	☐
Use of Funds	Clear capital objective, amount needed, timeline, and deployment plan	☐	☐	☐
Repayment / Return Logic	Debt repayment plan, investor return story, or impact/outcome logic	☐	☐	☐
Channel Strategy	Clear sales channels, customer acquisition path, retail/distribution plan, or recurring revenue engine	☐	☐	☐
Operations Readiness	Inventory, vendors, fulfillment, staffing, systems, and capacity to execute after funding	☐	☐	☐
Founder Preparedness	Pitch clarity, coachability, responsiveness, follow-up discipline, and realistic expectations	☐	☐	☐

Scoring Guide: 0-6 = Strengthen the business before outreach. 7-11 = Prepare materials and pursue selective opportunities. 12-16 = Begin targeted outreach and pipeline tracking.

02 | Capital Fit Matrix

Use this matrix to narrow funding lanes before applying. The objective is to avoid chasing every opportunity and instead focus on the most realistic capital pathway for your current business model.

STAGE / MODEL	COMMON NEED	BEST-FIT CAPITAL PATHS	WATCHOUT
Pre-revenue / prototype	Product development, testing, market validation	Grants, pitch competitions, accelerators, friends/family, catalytic pilot dollars	Avoid debt until demand is clearer.
Early revenue under \$50K	Working capital, small equipment, early inventory	CDFI, SBA microloan, local grants, accelerator programs	Prepare basic financials and use-of-funds.
\$50K-\$250K revenue	Inventory, marketing, retail prep, production scale	CDFI, revenue-based financing, supplier programs, purchase order financing	Check margins and repayment pressure.
\$250K-\$1M revenue	Retail expansion, wholesale, hiring, operations	RBF, receivables financing, bank line, angel, corporate programs	Use forecasts and channel economics.
\$1M+ revenue	Scale, national retail, acquisitions, growth team	Bank financing, strategic investors, family offices, venture, PRI if impact aligned	Prepare diligence-ready data room.
SaaS / recurring revenue	Hiring, product roadmap, customer acquisition	Receivables, subscription monetization, angels, VC if scale profile fits	Prepare MRR, churn, cohorts, CAC, LTV.
Impact / community model	Pilot, program expansion, community outcomes	PRI, recoverable grants, impact investors, foundations, CDFI	Define impact metrics and repayment path.

03 | Capital Data Room Checklist

Create a clean folder before outreach. Funders should not have to chase basic documents. Use the existing Brand Blueprint resources where noted instead of creating duplicate files.

01 Company Documents

- ☐ Formation documents
- ☐ EIN confirmation
- ☐ Operating agreement or bylaws
- ☐ Business licenses
- ☐ Insurance certificates

02 Financials

- ☐ Profit and loss statement
- ☐ Balance sheet
- ☐ 12-month cashflow forecast
- ☐ Business bank statements
- ☐ Existing debt or financing obligations

03 Revenue + Traction

- ☐ Shopify, Stripe, Amazon, Faire, wholesale, or POS exports
- ☐ Customer contracts or purchase orders
- ☐ AR aging report
- ☐ Top SKU or service revenue summary
- ☐ Customer testimonials or case studies

04 Operations

- ☐ Inventory report
- ☐ Vendor and manufacturer agreements
- ☐ 3PL or fulfillment documents
- ☐ Team or contractor roster
- ☐ Systems, tools, and operating workflow

05 Capital Materials

- ☐ Use-of-funds summary
- ☐ Pitch deck or lender package
- ☐ Executive summary
- ☐ Capital ask and timeline

☐ Repayment, return, or impact logic

04 | Funding Outreach Library

Use these templates as starting points. Customize every message with your revenue, capital need, use of funds, and reason for fit. Keep outreach specific, concise, and easy to respond to.

Revenue-Based Financing / Ecommerce Advance

Hello [Name],

We are exploring non-dilutive working capital for [Brand Name]. We currently generate approximately \$[monthly revenue] through [Shopify/Amazon/wholesale] and are seeking \$[amount] to support [inventory/marketing/PO fulfillment].

Please share your initial qualification requirements, estimated funding range, fee structure, repayment mechanics, and required platform integrations. We can provide sales exports, SKU performance, marketing performance, and bank statements for review.

Best regards,
[Founder Name]

CDFI / SBA Microloan

Hello [Name],

I am reaching out to determine fit for a CDFI or SBA Microloan for [Company Name]. We are seeking approximately \$[amount] to support [working capital/equipment/inventory/operations].

We are prepared to share our business overview, use-of-funds summary, cashflow forecast, business financials, and owner background. I would appreciate guidance on eligibility, documentation, timeline, and next steps.

Best regards,
[Founder Name]

Receivables / Subscription Financing

Hello [Name],

[Company Name] is evaluating financing options tied to receivables or recurring revenue. We currently have [MRR/ARR/contract revenue] and are seeking \$[amount] to support [hiring/growth/product/customer acquisition].

We can provide MRR/ARR schedule, churn data, AR aging, customer contracts, and revenue history. Please share your advance rates, fees, repayment structure, covenants, and qualification criteria.

Best regards,
[Founder Name]

Mission / PRI Capital

Hello [Name],

I am reaching out to explore whether [Company Name/Initiative] may align with your mission investing or catalytic capital priorities. Our work focuses on [impact area], and we are seeking \$[amount] to support [pilot/expansion/program growth].

Attached is a short memo outlining the opportunity, impact metrics, use of funds, repayment or recoverable structure, and expected outcomes. I would welcome a brief fit conversation.

Best regards,
[Founder Name]

Corporate Accelerator / Supplier Program

Hello [Name],

My name is [Founder Name], founder of [Brand Name], a [category] brand focused on [positioning]. We would like to be considered for [program/supplier opportunity].

We can provide our buyer brief, UPC list, pricing, MOQ, product spec sheet, current traction, and promotional support plan. Please let us know the best submission path and whether RangeMe or a direct review is preferred.

Best regards,
[Founder Name]

05 | 30-Day Capital Access Action Plan

TIMING	ACTION	OWNER	STATUS
Week 1	Complete readiness scorecard; identify the top three gaps; update business financials.		☐ Not Started ☐ In Progress ☐ Complete
Week 2	Complete the fit matrix; select one primary capital path and one secondary path.		☐ Not Started ☐ In Progress ☐ Complete
Week 3	Build the capital data room; update use of funds; gather platform exports and financials.		☐ Not Started ☐ In Progress ☐ Complete
Week 4	Customize outreach; enter opportunities into tracker; send first targeted applications or introductions.		☐ Not Started ☐ In Progress ☐ Complete

Module Integration Notes

Forecasting + KPI Workbook: Use for revenue assumptions, margins, cash needs, and repayment planning.

Pitch Deck Builder: Use for investor, accelerator, family office, and strategic partner conversations.

Retail Readiness Toolkit: Use when supplier programs, retail accelerators, or buyer-facing opportunities are the funding path.

Growth OS: Use after funding to manage execution, accountability, and operating cadence.

Final Thought: The goal is not simply to raise money. The goal is to secure the right capital, at the right time, for the right purpose.